

How **ELECTRONIC DETECTION** Can Save Buried And Drowning People

Possibilities of human fatalities in such situations as earthquakes, floods and collapse of infrastructure, among others, has inspired many recent technological advancements in the expanding field of human safety



Dr S.S. Verma is professor at Department of Physics, Sant Longowal Institute of Engineering and Technology, Sangrur, Punjab

Frequent natural calamities such as avalanches, landslides, earthquakes, volcanic eruptions and floods, along with the menace of low-quality materials in infrastructure development are always leading to untimely collapse of flyovers, bridges, roads and buildings, resulting in casualties. Similarly, there are numerous reasons for drowning also, like excessive rainfall, unwarranted release of water from dams, accidents in water bodies or, more concerning, suicide attempts.

In all these mentioned reasons, life of people is always under threat. Although, search and rescue operations/missions are immediately set out to find the victims trapped underneath the wreckage, during these missions, time is critical, and the ability to quickly detect living victims greatly increases the chances of their rescue and survival.

Society, relatives and the administration will no doubt whole-heartedly try to save people's lives in such situations. Recovery of buried and underwater



The American rescue team using *FINDER* in the recent Nepal earthquake (Credit: www.jpl.nasa.gov)